Phishing

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Phishing is a common form of internet fraud where criminals impersonate legitimate companies or individuals to steal sensitive data, such as passwords, credit card numbers, and personal information. These attacks often occur via email, text messages, or phone calls.

Common Attack Methods:

- Email Phishing: Criminals send urgent messages—often claiming an account is compromised—with links to fake, fraudulent websites designed to capture login credentials.
- Vishing: Fraudsters call victims, often posing as tech support, to gain remote access to computers or trick users into paying for fake virus removal services.
- Smishing: The use of deceptive text messages to bait users into revealing information.
- Whaling: Targeted phishing attacks aimed at high-level executives or company owners.
- Spear Phishing: Attacks customized for a specific individual or small group rather than the general public.

How to Protect Yourself:

- Be Skeptical: Legitimate organizations rarely pressure you to act urgently; if a message feels suspicious, treat it with caution.
- Verify Links: Hover your mouse cursor over links to inspect the actual destination URL before clicking to ensure it leads to a known, legitimate domain.
- Use Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): Enabling MFA adds a critical layer of security by requiring verification beyond just a password, making it harder for unauthorized parties to access accounts.
- Data Privacy: Minimize your footprint online by removing personal information from data broker websites that sell user details to spammers and telemarketers.